Eventually we cruised to a win, thanks to a courageous knock from Pujara, who batted with a broken finger and remained unbeaten on 82. It was an act of real courage and will do him a lot of good in the rest of his career.

It was the first time in our history that we had achieved a 4–0 series win against Australia and the victory could not have come at a better time for Indian cricket. At one swoop we had managed to erase the unpleasant memories of losing to England at home and the team had started to come together again.

From a personal point of view, I had started the series well in Chennai and had looked good in patches, but I lost my wicket after getting a start on at least three occasions. Unfortunately for me, I was not able to get a century in the 2012–13 season and it was something I was looking to change at the start of the following season.

New Zealand in India 2012

1st Test. Hyderabad (Deccan). 23–26 August 2012

India 438 (CA Pujara 159, MS Dhoni 73, V Kohli 58, V Sehwag 47, **SR Tendulkar 19**; JS Patel 4–100, TA Boult 3–93)

New Zealand 159 (JEC Franklin 43*; R Ashwin 6–31, PP Ojha 3–44) and 164 (f/o) (KS Williamson 52, BB McCullum 42; R Ashwin 6–54, PP Ojha 3–48)

India won by an innings and 115 runs

2nd Test. Bangalore. 31 August–3 September 2012

New Zealand 365 (LRPL Taylor 113, CFK van Wyk 71, MJ Guptil 53; PP Ojha 5–99) and 248 (JEC Franklin 41; R Ashwin 5–69, PP Ojha 2–49, UT Yadav 2–68)

India 353 (V Kohli 103, MS Dhoni 62, SK Raina 55, **SR Tendulkar 17**; TG Southee 7–64) and 262–5 (V Kohli 51*, CA Pujara 48, **SR Tendulkar 27**; JS Patel 3–68)

India won by 5 wickets

India won the series 2–0

England in India 2012

1st Test. Ahmedabad. 15–19 November 2012

India 521–8 dec (CA Pujara 206*, V Sehwag 117, Y Singh 74, **SR Tendulkar 13**; GP Swann 5–144) and 80–1 (CA Pujara 41*)